

Raw notes - Campus departure interview 1

- Interviewer: Oleh Goumain
- Notetaker: Jiawen Li
- Interview date, time, and time zone: 09/29/2026, 3:40 pm, EDT
- Participant: Tristan, sophomore (experienced student) who walks between buildings on the Morningside campus several times a day; fits because he regularly has tight turnarounds between classes
- Permission to take notes: "Yeah, that's fine, just don't use my last name."

Questions and participant's words

1. **Context:** "Today I went from Mudd to Hamilton. I had ten minutes and made it, but I basically speed-walked."
2. **Hardest part or what works well:** "Honestly, guessing how long it'll take. Sometimes it's six minutes, sometimes it's twelve if the elevator's slow or the hallway's packed."
3. **Last specific incident, how it happened, frequency, and consequence:** "Last Tuesday. I left my lab right when it ended, figured ten minutes was plenty, got stuck waiting for the elevator, and walked in about four minutes late. The professor didn't say anything but I missed the attendance quiz. (He said the lab ended on time; the issue was the trip, not getting out of the previous class.)"
4. **Current approach and how well it works:** "I just leave as soon as class ends and walk fast. I check Google Maps sometimes for new buildings. It's fine for buildings I know, not great for ones I don't."
5. **Money spent specifically on this problem:** "No. Nothing."
6. **First reaction to the concept, after section 4:** "Huh. Okay, that could be useful for new buildings. For ones I already know, I don't think I'd use it."
7. **Biggest concern:** "Another notification. I already ignore most of them. And I'd have to give it my location all the time, which I'm not thrilled about."
8. **Referral and follow-up response:** "Yeah, my friend Dana is a first-year and gets lost all the time. I can introduce you. And sure, you can follow up." (approximate paraphrase)
9. **Other comments or follow-ups actually asked:**
 - Asked: "Tell me about the last time that approach failed." Tristan: "That was the Tuesday thing. I just assumed the elevator would be quick."

Interviewer observations, separate from their words

Tristan sped up and gestured when telling the elevator story. He shrugged when asked about money. His tone dropped when he mentioned location tracking. (Interpretation, mine: the problem is real but small and mostly limited to unfamiliar buildings or bad elevator luck.)

Skipped questions

None.